

# UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

## INSTRUCTIONS

1. This paper contains 100 questions. Each question has four alternatives.
2. Each correct response carries 2 marks; one-third of the marks assigned to a question (shown as 0.66) is deducted for an incorrect response; an unattempted question carries zero.
3. Current-affairs content is limited to information available on or before 2026-09-10.

Q1. Registrar architecture remedial Which institutional statement is correct?

|                                                                                                          |                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. State Registrars administer State-law societies, while the Central Registrar administers the MSCS Act | B. The Ministry of Cooperation is the Registrar for all State societies |
| C. The Central Registrar regulates all PACS                                                              | D. RBI incorporates every non-banking cooperative                       |

Q2. Ministry-size controls Consider the following: 1. Union ministry: maximum 15% of Lok Sabha strength. 2. State ministry: maximum 15% of Legislative Assembly strength. 3. State ministry: constitutional minimum of 12. 4. These caps were introduced by the 91st Amendment. Which is correct?

|                    |                  |
|--------------------|------------------|
| A. 1 and 4 only    | B. 1, 2, 3 and 4 |
| C. 1, 2 and 4 only | D. 2 and 3 only  |

Q3. Which statement correctly distinguishes an effective majority from the Article 368 majority?

|                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. They are identical because vacancies are ignored in both.                                                                                                                         | B. Article 368 uses only two-thirds of effective strength.              |
| C. An effective majority uses the House's then-existing strength after vacancies; Article 368 separately requires a majority of total membership plus two-thirds present and voting. | D. Effective majority is the State-ratification rule under Article 368. |

Q4. Which statement about Articles 371 to 371J is correct?

|                                                                      |                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. They create a single identical package of powers for every State. | B. They grant separate national citizenship to their beneficiary populations.                                    |
| C. They operate only during a National Emergency.                    | D. They contain differentiated State-specific arrangements responding to distinct historical and regional needs. |

Q5. Which statement correctly captures the relationship among Fundamental Rights, DPSP and Fundamental Duties?

|                                                                                              |                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| A. They differ in legal status but jointly connect liberty, welfare and civic responsibility | B. All three are directly enforceable by writ             |
| C. DPSP automatically override every Fundamental Right                                       | D. Duties apply only to governments and never to citizens |

Q6. Which statement correctly describes creation or abolition of a State Legislative Council?

|                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Parliament and the State Assembly both act by an ordinary present-and-voting majority. | B. The State Assembly first passes the Article 169 resolution by its prescribed special majority; Parliament then enacts an ordinary law outside Article 368. |
| C. The Governor creates or abolishes the Council after Parliament approves a resolution.  | D. The change always requires an Article 368 amendment ratified by half the States.                                                                           |

Q7. Constitutional status Which statement is constitutionally correct?

|                                                                                                                          |                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Hindi is the national language and English is its subordinate associate language.                                     | B. All Eighth-Schedule languages are official languages of the Union. |
| C. Hindi in Devanagari script is the official language of the Union, but the Constitution declares no national language. | D. English is the sole official language named in Article 343.        |

Q8. Which case-description pair is incorrectly stated?

|                                                                                           |                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. John Vallamattom - discriminatory succession restriction and an Article 44 observation | B. Sarla Mudgal - conversion cannot be used to evade an existing marriage               |
| C. Shah Bano - secular maintenance law and an Article 44 observation                      | D. Shayara Bano - Supreme Court ordered Parliament to enact a UCC within a fixed period |

Q9. Advisory jurisdiction Which statement about Article 143 is correct?

|                                                                                                     |                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. The President refers; an Article 143(1) opinion is advisory and the Court may decline to answer. | B. A private party may demand an advisory opinion.                           |
| C. Every opinion binds future benches exactly like Article 141 precedent.                           | D. The Court may grant deemed assent to legislation through every reference. |

Q10. Pre-2011 position Which statement correctly describes the position before the 97th Amendment?

|                                                                      |                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. No cooperative could be incorporated before Article 43B           | B. Cooperatives already existed as statutory bodies under Union or State legislation within the federal competence split |
| C. Part IXB was the sole source of all cooperative legal personality | D. Only Parliament could legislate for every cooperative                                                                 |

Q11. Financial Bill-II Which statement correctly describes an Article 117(3) Financial Bill?

|                                                                                                        |                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| A. It is a Money Bill.                                                                                 | B. It can originate only in Lok Sabha.     |
| C. It may originate in either House, but presidential recommendation is required before consideration. | D. Rajya Sabha may only recommend changes. |

Q12. Article 311 coverage Which statement about Article 311 is correct?

|                                                                   |                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. It protects every employee of a government-controlled company. | B. It applies only to permanent gazetted officers.                                                          |
| C. It bars all transfers, suspensions and prosecutions.           | D. It protects listed civil-service members and civil-post holders against specified punitive consequences. |

Q13. Which statement about Udyam is most accurate?

|                                                                                           |                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A. It provides an official registration identity but not assured finance or productivity. | B. It guarantees collateral-free credit.          |
| C. It is a product-quality certification.                                                 | D. It replaces every tax and labour registration. |

Q14. Which statement best distinguishes PDS targeting errors?

|                                             |                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. All three mean the same missing stock.   | B. Exclusion denies an eligible person; inclusion covers an ineligible record; leakage diverts entitled grain. |
| C. Exclusion is always fiscally beneficial. | D. Leakage occurs only before procurement.                                                                     |

Q15. Which statement about nano urea is evidence-disciplined?

|                                                                                                                   |                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. One bottle universally replaces one bag in every crop.                                                         | B. Regulatory approval proves identical yield in every soil.  |
| C. Use should follow crop-soil protocols; notification does not prove universal replacement of conventional urea. | D. Nano urea supplies phosphorus and potassium automatically. |

Q16. Which statement about APMC law is correct?

|                                                            |                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Parliament enacted one uniform APMC Act for all States. | B. e-NAM automatically repealed every APMC statute.                                                           |
| C. CCI directly administers all market yards.              | D. APMCs operate under applicable State marketing laws whose notified produce, areas, licences and fees vary. |

Q17. Which statement correctly maps competition oversight?

|                                                                                                                                                |                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A. State market authorities shape mandi architecture, while CCI addresses anti-competitive conduct under the Competition Act where applicable. | B. CCI writes every State APMC Act.                   |
| C. APMC committees decide all national cartel cases.                                                                                           | D. A large buyer is automatically an unlawful cartel. |

Q18. Which statement about duration is correct? 1. Modified duration approximates percentage price sensitivity to a small yield change. 2. Longer duration generally means greater interest-rate sensitivity. 3. Duration is the probability of issuer default.

|           |                 |
|-----------|-----------------|
| A. 1 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
|-----------|-----------------|

|                 |               |
|-----------------|---------------|
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3 |
|-----------------|---------------|

Q19. Which statement about ICSID and India is correct at the cutoff?

|                                                                                 |                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| A. India joined automatically through IBRD membership                           | B. ICSID is a sovereign lender to India                   |
| C. India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State to the ICSID Convention | D. Every investor dispute automatically falls under ICSID |

Q20. Which statement correctly distinguishes supply chain from value chain?

|                                                           |                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. They are legally identical terms under every APMC Act. | B. A value chain excludes logistics and payment.                                                             |
| C. A supply chain measures only farmer profit.            | D. A supply chain maps flows; a value chain also studies value creation, governance and margin distribution. |

Q21. Which statement about temperature is correct?

|                                                                                          |                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A. Different commodities require different temperature, humidity and handling protocols. | B. All perishables use one universal temperature. |
| C. Frozen and chilled storage are identical.                                             | D. Cooling always improves every commodity.       |

Q22. Consider the following statements about a listed green debt security: 1. Its proceeds are linked to eligible environmental purposes. 2. Additional allocation and impact disclosures address greenwashing. 3. Its label guarantees repayment. Which statements are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 only       | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q23. Which statement about land ceilings is correct?

|                                                                                                     |                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. They merge scattered parcels without changing ownership.                                         | B. They automatically transfer every leased plot to its tenant. |
| C. They set a State-law maximum and identify legally surplus land, subject to units and exemptions. | D. They are fixed uniformly by one Union statute.               |

Q24. Which statement correctly distinguishes irrigation potential and utilisation?

|                                                  |                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Potential is crop output per litre.           | B. Utilisation is identical to gross irrigated area in every dataset.                        |
| C. Potential proves equitable tail-end delivery. | D. Potential is designed capacity; utilisation is the area actually served under the system. |

Q25. Consider the following statements: 1. Lothal is useful for bead-working and a basin conventionally identified as a dockyard. 2. Dholavira is useful for reservoirs and a large signboard. 3. Kalibangan is useful for a ploughed-field association. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1, 2 and 3   | B. 1 only       |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q26. Which pair best illustrates Buddhist lay patronage in texts?

|                              |                                 |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| A. Kharavela and Rudradaman. | B. Anathapindika and Visakha.   |
| C. Gargi and Maitreyi.       | D. Bhadrabahu and Sthulabhadra. |

Q27. Which deity-function pair is correctly matched?

|                                                                                   |                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Varuna-only chariot manufacture, without chronological or source qualification | B. Ushas-land-tax collection, as a direct material and social identity   |
| C. Agni-sacrificial mediation, as a complete territorial institution              | D. Soma-territorial surveying, throughout every region and textual layer |

Q28. Which one of the following statements about Harappan script is most accurate?

|                                                          |                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. It is conclusively Brahmi written only left to right. | B. It has yielded a continuous historical chronicle.                                                       |
| C. It provides king-lists comparable to Mesopotamia.     | D. It is undeciphered; short inscriptions and seal context can be analysed without claiming a translation. |

Q29. With reference to Vijayanagara & the Bahmani Kingdom (Deccan), consider the following statements: 1. The Tungabhadra doab was fertile and strategically placed between the two powers. 2. The Krishna-Godavari basin had fertile

land and ports controlling regional foreign trade. 3. Talikota immediately ended every remnant of Vijayanagara. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q30. With reference to The Bhakti & Sufi Movements, consider the following statements: 1. In north India the two major ba-shara orders were Chishti and Suhrawardi. 2. Chishtis such as Muinuddin Chishti, Bakhtiyar Kaki, Baba Farid, Nizamuddin Auliya and Nasiruddin Chiragh-i-Delhi stressed simplicity, poverty, service, sama and distance from politics. 3. Kabir was a state-backed social reformer. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q31. With reference to Art, Architecture & Culture of the Sultanate, consider the following statements: 1. Arches, vaults and domes had long histories in India and West/central Asia. Sultanate workshops expanded particular arcuate geometries, centring and lime-mortar construction without a single-event "introduction." 2. Indigenous craftsmen-stone-cutters, masons and others-were central to Sultanate construction. 3. Arch and dome were invented by the Turks. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q32. With reference to Babur & the Central Asian Backdrop, consider the following statements: 1. The Timurid world fragmented after Timur and Shahrukh; Timurid princes repeatedly fought each other, allowing the Uzbeks in Trans-Oxiana and the Safavids in Iran to rise. 2. Babur twice won Samarkand but could not hold it; after Uzbek pressure, he shifted to Kabul (1504). 3. Babur came only because Indian nobles invited him. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q33. With reference to India and Her Neighbours (Frontier Policy), consider the following statements: 1. British rulers treated India's neighbours as part of a defensive ring around the empire. 2. Afghanistan became central because of fear of Russian advance in Central Asia, often called the Great Game. 3. Burma was always separate from British India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q34. With reference to Foundation of the INC & the Moderate Phase (1885-1905), consider the following statements: 1. Before 1885, educated Indians formed provincial and imperial associations such as the Landholders' Society, British Indian Association, East India Association, Poona Sarvajanik Sabha, Indian Association, Madras Mahajan Sabha and Bombay Presidency Association. 2. These bodies trained early leaders in petitions, public meetings, memorials, press campaigns and constitutional criticism of colonial rule. 3. The INC was created only by the British as a safety valve. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q35. With reference to Militant Nationalism, Swadeshi & the Partition of Bengal, consider the following statements: 1. Militant nationalism grew because many nationalists were dissatisfied with Moderate methods and slow constitutional concessions. 2. Curzon's reactionary measures, including the Calcutta Corporation Act and Universities Act, deepened distrust of official reform. 3. Separate electorates were introduced by the Government of India Act 1919. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q36. With reference to Revolutionary Nationalism (Phase I, 1907-1917), consider the following statements: 1. After the Swadeshi movement declined under repression, some young nationalists turned to individual heroism, secret societies and armed action. 2. They believed that dramatic attacks on officials could inspire courage, avenge repression and awaken the nation. 3. Revolutionary nationalism was the same as Gandhian mass satyagraha. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q37. With reference to Growth of Communalism & the Muslim League, consider the following statements: 1. Bipan Chandra treats communalism as a modern ideology that converts religious identity into claims about shared secular and political interests; this is a source interpretation, not a synonym for religion. 2. Communalism is not the same as religion, religious reform or personal religiosity. 3. Separate electorates began with the Government of India Act 1919. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q38. With reference to First World War, Home Rule League & the Lucknow Pact, consider the following statements: 1. India supported Britain in World War I with men, money and materials; Indian leaders initially expected that loyalty would be rewarded with constitutional reforms. 2. Wartime conditions produced discontent: rising prices, heavier taxation, war loans, shortages and recruitment pressure made British rule appear more exploitative. 3. Separate electorates began with the Lucknow Pact. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q39. Which statement is NOT supported by the repaired source base?

|                                                                                                                              |                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Ajanta's cave count should not be the analytical point because unfinished or late-counted caves complicate simple totals. | B. Amaravati's lower Krishna location is a tested prelims discriminator.  |
| C. Elephanta's exact dynastic patronage is fully settled and should be stated without caution.                               | D. Hathigumpha is a major narrative source that still requires criticism. |

Q40. Which site-feature pair is correctly matched?

|                                                           |                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Lothal - securely identified royal palace              | B. Dholavira - absence of reservoirs                          |
| C. Kalibangan - exact copy of Mohenjo-daro in all details | D. Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath and integrated drainage emphasis |

Q41. Which statement about Nataraja chronology is safest?

|                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Pre-Chola antecedents are known, including the Ravana Phadi cave at Aihole, while Chola bronzes gave the form its canonical portable expression. | B. The Cholas invented the Nataraja image from nothing.                 |
| C. The earliest known Nataraja in the source bank is a Mughal-period bronze.                                                                        | D. Nataraja belongs to Buddhist iconography rather than Shaiva imagery. |

Q42. Which statement best explains guru-shishya parampara?

|                                                             |                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. It is merely a modern bureaucratic exam system.          | B. It is the embodied transmission mechanism through which technique, correction and sampradaya survive across generations. |
| C. It means every form has only one correct national style. | D. It eliminates the need for rehearsal.                                                                                    |

Q43. Which statement best explains the rise of regional miniature schools after Mughal contraction?

|                                                                                                                                       |                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Regional schools arose because all earlier manuscript traditions disappeared.                                                      | B. Regional schools rejected all earlier Persianate or Indian influences. |
| C. Reduced central patronage and the movement of artists helped regional courts adapt shared miniature resources in distinctive ways. | D. Only one regional school survived, so comparison is unnecessary.       |

Q44. Which statement about the 1927 Parliament building is safest?

|                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Its design was conclusively proved by official records to be copied from Mitaoli. | B. It was designed by Bimal Patel for the Central Vista project.                                                                                         |
| C. It was demolished after the new Parliament was opened.                            | D. It belongs to the Lutyens-Baker imperial Delhi phase, and the Mitaoli influence claim should be treated as debated rather than documentary certainty. |

Q45. With reference to The Arctic or Polar Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Polar climate lies mainly north of the Arctic Circle; ice-cap (Greenland) vs tundra (lowlands). 2. Warmest month < ~10°C; ≤ 4 months above freezing; low

snow precipitation -> cold desert. 3. "Ice-cap" and "tundra" are the same. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q46. With reference to World Population and Demographic Transition, consider the following statements: 1. In demographic transition, death rates usually fall before birth rates. 2. Population pyramid = age-sex structure at a glance. 3. Stage 2 means both birth and death rates fall together. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q47. With reference to Migration: Theories and Spatial Patterns, consider the following statements: 1. Migration is a component of population change, along with fertility and mortality. 2. Push and pull can operate together; the same factor may push one group and attract another. 3. Refugees and voluntary emigrants are the same. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q48. With reference to Human Settlements and Urbanisation, consider the following statements: 1. Settlement pattern and settlement function are not the same thing. 2. Dispersed settlements often reflect terrain, farm size or resource spread. 3. A metropolis and a conurbation are identical. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q49. With reference to Regional Development and Five-Year Plans, consider the following statements: 1. Regional development is about territorial balance, not just national GDP growth. 2. Growth can spread outward or create backwash and dependency. 3. Balanced regional development means every place must grow at the same rate. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q50. With reference to Primary Economic Activities: Agriculture, consider the following statements: 1. Shifting cultivation uses temporary plots and fallow rotation; it is not the same as plantation farming. 2. Plantation agriculture is large-scale, monocultural and export-oriented. 3. All large farms are commercial grain farms. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q51. With reference to Mineral & Energy Resources: Classification, World Belts & Strategic Significance, consider the following statements: 1. Ferrous minerals are centred on iron-steel systems; non-ferrous include copper and bauxite. 2. Coal and petroleum occur mainly in sedimentary formations. 3. All minerals are renewable because they can be recycled. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q52. With reference to Industries & Industrial Regions, consider the following statements: 1. Weber's model is a least-cost industrial-location theory. 2. Raw-material orientation is strongest where inputs are bulky or lose weight during processing. 3. An industrial region is just a resource region. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q53. With reference to Transport, Trade & Space Networks, consider the following statements: 1. Roads are best for flexible last-mile movement. 2. Rail is well suited to bulk inland freight. 3. Trade geography is only about exports and imports. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
|-----------------|-----------------|

|                 |               |
|-----------------|---------------|
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3 |
|-----------------|---------------|

Q54. With reference to World Regional Geography: Continents, Regions & Country Groupings, consider the following statements: 1. Asia is the largest continent in both area and population in the source framework. 2. Antarctica is a polar desert despite its ice cover. 3. North America and Latin America are identical categories. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q55. With reference to Political Geography: Boundaries, Frontiers & Geopolitical Theories, consider the following statements: 1. River boundaries can become disputed when the channel shifts. 2. Watershed boundaries are common in mountain regions. 3. Geopolitical theory is separate from geography. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q56. With reference to Contemporary Geographical Issues: Conceptual Lenses for India, consider the following statements: 1. A dispute is geographical when terrain or basin structure materially shapes it. 2. A hazard becomes a governance issue when land use amplifies natural exposure. 3. Urban flooding is only due to heavy rain. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q57. With reference to Renewable Energy and Green Hydrogen, consider the following statements: 1. Green hydrogen is produced via electrolysis powered by renewable electricity, distinguishing it from grey hydrogen (fossil-fuel-based, no capture) and blue hydrogen (fossil-fuel-based, with carbon capture). 2. The National Green Hydrogen Mission, approved in January 2023, targets 5 million metric tonnes per annum of green-hydrogen production capacity by 2030. 3. Allocated green-hydrogen capacity means green hydrogen is being produced at that scale. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q58. With reference to Disaster Management Framework and Sendai, consider the following statements: 1. The Disaster Management Act, 2005 established a three-tier structure: NDMA (chaired by the Prime Minister), SDMA (chaired by the Chief Minister) and DDMA (chaired by the District Magistrate/Collector). 2. The Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030 was adopted in 2015 at the UN's Third World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction in Sendai, Japan, succeeding the Hyogo Framework for Action. 3. The Sendai Framework's "global targets" and its "priorities for action" are the same list. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q59. With reference to Environmental Institutions MoEFCC CPCB NBA WII, consider the following statements: 1. MoEFCC is India's nodal ministry for environmental policy and international convention implementation. 2. CPCB is the apex pollution-regulation body under the Water Act, 1974 and Air Act, 1981. 3. NTCA and WCCB are the same body with different names. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q60. With reference to Ecosystem Structure and Function, consider the following statements: 1. It is a zone of variable width and a zone of ecological tension/competition, not a line on a map. 2. Decomposers are heterotrophic and act on dead organic matter; detritivores (e.g., earthworms) physically fragment it before microbial decomposition. 3. An ecotone is simply a boundary line. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q61. With reference to Biogeochemical Cycles and Ecological Pyramids, consider the following statements: 1. It is a sedimentary cycle with negligible atmospheric presence. 2. Phosphorus has no significant atmospheric phase, unlike

carbon and nitrogen. 3. Phosphorus cycle has a major atmospheric phase like carbon. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q62. With reference to Ecological Succession and Biomes, consider the following statements: 1. The sere is the whole sequence; a seral stage is one community within it. 2. A climax community is relatively stable but not permanently fixed - a major disturbance can reset succession. 3. "Sere" and "seral stage" mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q63. With reference to Biodiversity Levels and Hotspots, consider the following statements: 1. Alpha diversity is within-habitat diversity (richness and evenness); richness is only the species count. 2. India hosts four global biodiversity hotspots: Himalaya, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats-Sri Lanka, and Sundaland (represented in India by the Nicobar Islands). 3. Alpha diversity and species richness are the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q64. With reference to IUCN Red List and Endemism, consider the following statements: 1. It means there is insufficient information to assess risk, which can itself warrant precautionary conservation attention. 2. Data Deficient does not mean a species is safe - it means insufficient data exists to assess its risk. 3. Data Deficient means a species is not at risk. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q65. With reference to Protected Area Network India, consider the following statements: 1. ESZ extent is site-specific and fixed by the individual notification; there is no automatic uniform statutory width. 2. Conservation Reserves and Community Reserves were introduced by a later (2002) amendment to extend protection to buffer and community/private lands. 3. Every protected area has a uniform 10 km Eco-Sensitive Zone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q66. With reference to Biosphere Reserves and Ramsar Sites, consider the following statements: 1. The Montreux Record sits within the Ramsar List; it flags adverse ecological change and triggers advisory assistance, not delisting. 2. The Ramsar Convention (1971) is specifically about wetlands, named after the city of Ramsar, Iran, where it was signed. 3. Being on the Montreux Record means a site has lost Ramsar status. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q67. With reference to Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules, consider the following statements: 1. CITES obligations are given domestic legal effect through instruments like the Wildlife Protection Act's Schedule IV structure. 2. The Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act, 2022 restructured the earlier six-schedule system into four schedules. 3. CITES itself is enforced directly in India without domestic legislation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q68. With reference to CITES and Wildlife Trade, consider the following statements: 1. Appendix III listing is a unilateral act by a single Party; only Appendices I and II require a two-thirds CoP majority. 2. CITES came into force in 1975; decisions on Appendix listings are made at its periodic Conference of the Parties (CoP). 3. Adding a species to Appendix III requires a CoP vote. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q69. With reference to General Science: Physics Fundamentals, consider the following statements: 1. Newton's third law explains action-reaction pairs; the two forces act on different bodies. 2. Work is zero if there is no displacement in the direction of force, even if force is applied. 3. Escape velocity depends on the mass of the object being launched. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q70. With reference to General Science: Chemistry Fundamentals, consider the following statements: 1. Atomic number, not atomic mass, is the basis of the modern periodic table. 2. Alkali metals are highly reactive metals; halogens are highly reactive non-metals. 3. A catalyst increases the yield of a reaction at equilibrium. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q71. With reference to General Science: Biology and Physiology, consider the following statements: 1. Prokaryotic cells lack a true membrane-bound nucleus; eukaryotic cells possess one. 2. Mitochondria are linked with cellular respiration; chloroplasts with photosynthesis. 3. Virus and bacteria can be treated identically in biology questions. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q72. With reference to S&T Institutions: DST, CSIR, ANRF and SERB, consider the following statements: 1. DST was established in May 1971 as a nodal department for science and technology promotion and coordination. 2. CSIR's official page describes it as a network of 37 national laboratories with pan-India presence. 3. ANRF is just another live name for SERB with no structural change. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q73. With reference to Scientific Discoveries, Nobel Prizes and Scientists, consider the following statements: 1. Born in Cambridge, United Kingdom, in 1942. 2. Affiliated at the time of the award with the University of California, Berkeley, USA. 3. A current-affairs name list is sufficient. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q74. With reference to Space Programme, ISRO, Launch Vehicles and Space Governance, consider the following statements: 1. The policy separates public, regulatory and commercial roles; it does not abolish state leadership. 2. PSLV is described by ISRO as the workhorse launcher with multiple variants and a strong success record. 3. Space Policy 2023 means the government has withdrawn from the space sector. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q75. With reference to Satellites, NavIC, GAGAN and Applications, consider the following statements: 1. NavIC is regional by design (India plus ~1500 km); this is a deliberate cost-and-coverage choice, not a shortfall. 2. GAGAN is a Satellite Based Augmentation System jointly developed by ISRO and AAI for civil-aviation navigation requirements. 3. NavIC is a global system like GPS/GLONASS/Galileo/BeiDou. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q76. With reference to Human Spaceflight, Gaganyaan and Planetary Missions, consider the following statements: 1. It is a solar observatory placed in halo orbit around Sun-Earth L1 for continuous observation. 2. The Gaganyaan orbital module consists of a Crew Module and a Service Module. 3. Aditya-L1 means India has "landed on the Sun.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

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| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q77. With reference to Nuclear Power and the Three-Stage Programme, consider the following statements: 1. Liability deals with compensation architecture; safety regulation is handled through regulatory oversight and standards. 2. Stage 2 centres on fast breeder reactors using plutonium to expand fissile-material availability. 3. Civil nuclear liability law is the same thing as reactor-safety regulation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q78. With reference to Nuclear Fusion and ITER, consider the following statements: 1. Q compares fusion power to injected plasma heating power only; it ignores magnets, cryopant, pumps and conversion losses. Engineering breakeven is a far higher bar. 2. ITER is an experimental project intended to demonstrate feasibility and bridge the gap toward later power-producing systems; it is not a commercial plant. 3. "Q = 10 means the plant produces ten times the electricity it consumes.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 2 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q79. With reference to Regulatory Governance and Independent Regulators, consider the following statements: 1. The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished several appellate tribunals/authorities (including under the Cinematograph Act, 1952; Trade Marks Act, 1999; Copyright Act, 1957; and certain Customs Act and Airports Authority of India Act appellate bodies), transferring their functions mainly to High Courts. 2. FSLRC (2013), chaired by Justice B.N. Srikrishna, proposed a Unified Financial Agency to subsume most financial regulators except the RBI - a proposal not implemented in full. 3. The Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021 abolished all tribunals in India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q80. With reference to Local Governance and Service Delivery, consider the following statements: 1. The 3Fs of effective devolution are Funds, Functions and Functionaries. 2. District Planning Committees consolidate Panchayat and Municipal development plans into a single district development plan. 3. District Planning Committees function uniformly and effectively across all states. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q81. With reference to Public Finance and Service-Delivery Tools, consider the following statements: 1. JAM stands for Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and Mobile - the technical foundation for India's digital financial-inclusion and benefit-transfer architecture. 2. PFMS is administered by the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance. 3. Any specific cumulative DBT savings figure is a fixed, permanently citable number. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q82. With reference to Participatory Governance, consider the following statements: 1. Subsidiarity holds that decisions should be made at the lowest level capable of handling them effectively, closest to those affected and to the relevant information. 2. The Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy of the Government of India dates to 2014. 3. Holding a Gram Sabha or Ward Committee meeting on schedule is itself proof of genuine participation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q83. With reference to Monitoring, Evaluation and Outcomes, consider the following statements: 1. DMEO was formed in 2015 by merging the Programme Evaluation Organisation and the Independent Evaluation Office under NITI Aayog. 2. The Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework is administered by the Ministry of Finance's Budget Division as part of the Union Budget process. 3. The Aspirational Districts Programme ranks districts only on their absolute performance level. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q84. With reference to Sports Governance, Institutions and Major Tournaments, consider the following statements: 1. Sports federation autonomy does not mean immunity from national law, anti-doping rules, financial accountability or judicial

review. 2. Recognition of a federation, selection of athletes and organisation of an event are distinct functions. 3. A wild card means rules do not apply. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q85. With reference to Salient Features and Diversity of Indian Society, consider the following statements: 1. Four major language families in India: Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic, Tibeto-Burman. 2. Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently lists 22 languages (constitutional detail; full doctrine is Polity's territory). 3. Every minority or tribal group is automatically marginalised. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q86. With reference to Caste System: Structure and Contemporary Dynamics, consider the following statements: 1. M.N. Srinivas coined both "Sanskritisation" and "dominant caste" based on his fieldwork in Rampura village, Karnataka. 2. Sanskritisation is upward emulation within the existing hierarchy; Westernisation introduces new values from Western contact - the two can occur together or separately. 3. Dominant caste always means the ritually highest caste. Which of the statements given above are correct?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q87. With reference to Tribe and Tribal Society, consider the following statements: 1. Verrier Elwin advocated isolation/protection; G.S. Ghurye advocated assimilation ("backward Hindus"); Jawaharlal Nehru's Panchsheel for Tribals advocated integration. 2. MoTA identifies 75 PVTGs in 18 States and the UT of Andaman & Nicobar Islands. Its legacy criteria include pre-agricultural level of technology, low literacy, stagnant/declining population and subsistence economy. 3. Elwin, Ghurye and Nehru held the same view on tribal policy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 2 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q88. With reference to Family, Marriage and Kinship, consider the following statements: 1. The Khasi of Meghalaya and, traditionally, the Nair of Kerala are the most commonly cited matrilineal kinship systems in India. 2. Gotra exogamy (marrying outside the paternal clan lineage) is observed widely alongside caste endogamy - the two rules are not contradictory. 3. Caste endogamy and gotra exogamy contradict each other. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 2 only |

Q89. With reference to Rural Society and Agrarian Change, consider the following statements: 1. M.N. Srinivas coined "dominant caste" from his Rampura (Karnataka) village fieldwork, the same study that produced "Sanskritisation." 2. Jajmani relationships were often hereditary and involved customary grain/in-kind payments, but local records also show cash and mixed forms; avoid treating "no cash" as a universal definition. 3. Dominant caste always means the ritually highest-ranked caste in a village. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q90. With reference to Population and Associated Issues, consider the following statements: 1. National Population Policy, 2000 set immediate, medium-term and long-term goals culminating in a stable population aligned with sustainable development. 2. Women's education is a major social determinant associated with fertility transition, alongside marriage age, health services, income, norms and state context. 3. National Population Policy, 2000 set a coercive one-child or two-child national target. Which of the statements given above are correct?

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|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q91. A policy analyst uses Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February 2026) to make the following claims: 1. The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q92. A policy analyst uses Economic Survey 2025-26 (29 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 3 only |

Q93. A policy analyst uses Economic Survey growth assessment (29 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outturn. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q94. A policy analyst uses RBI macro-risk assessment (5 August 2026) to make the following claims: 1. External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q95. A policy analyst uses India's 100th Ramsar site milestone (5 June 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q96. A policy analyst uses Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone (31 December 2025) to make the following claims: 1. Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 3 only |

Q97. A policy analyst uses Renewable-capacity addition (31 December 2025) to make the following claims: 1. Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 3 only | B. 1 and 2 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q98. A policy analyst uses Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex (21 June 2026) to make the following claims: 1. An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 1 and 3 only |
| C. 2 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q99. A policy analyst uses India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch (13 January 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category

must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1 and 3 only | D. 1, 2 and 3   |

Q100. A policy analyst uses BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement (16 May 2026) to make the following claims: 1. Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. 2. A dated target, allocation, approval or meeting may be treated as an achieved outcome without checking status. 3. The competent institution and legal category must be identified before drawing an inference. Which claims are methodologically sound?

|                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only |
| C. 1, 2 and 3   | D. 1 and 3 only |

END OF PAPER